

VENUS BANK

EMPLOYEE CODE OF CONDUCT

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Important Notice: This is a fictional sample document created for demonstration and RAG/AI testing purposes. It is not an official Venus Bank policy or legal guidance.

1. Purpose

The Employee Code of Conduct establishes the standards of professional, ethical, and responsible behavior expected from all Venus Bank employees.

Employees are expected to act with integrity, protect customer and company interests, comply with applicable requirements, and maintain a respectful workplace.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all Venus Bank employees, including permanent employees, trainees, interns, temporary employees, and employees working remotely.

Third-party contractors and consultants may be subject to equivalent conduct requirements under their contractual arrangements.

3. Professional Conduct

Employees must:

- Act honestly, ethically, and professionally.
- Treat colleagues, customers, vendors, and business partners with respect.
- Perform assigned responsibilities diligently and responsibly.
- Follow approved company processes and internal controls.
- Protect the reputation and interests of Venus Bank.
- Report suspected misconduct or policy violations through approved channels.

Employees must not engage in behavior that could damage customer trust, workplace safety, or the reputation of the bank.

4. Respectful Workplace

Venus Bank maintains a workplace that is free from harassment, bullying, discrimination, intimidation, and retaliation.

Employees must not discriminate against another person based on characteristics protected by applicable law or company policy.

Unwelcome verbal, physical, written, or electronic conduct may be considered inappropriate and may be subject to investigation.

5. Confidentiality

Employees may have access to confidential information relating to:

- Customers
- Employees
- Financial transactions
- Business operations
- Technology systems
- Bank strategies
- Internal reports
- Third-party partners

Employees must only access confidential information when required for legitimate business purposes.

Confidential information must not be disclosed to unauthorized individuals inside or outside the organization.

6. Customer Information

Customer information must be handled carefully and only accessed for legitimate business purposes.

Employees must not:

- Access customer accounts without a business requirement.
- Share customer information with unauthorized persons.
- Copy or transfer customer information to unauthorized systems.
- Use customer information for personal purposes.

Any suspected unauthorized access or disclosure must be reported immediately through the approved security or compliance channel.

7. Information Security

Employees must follow the bank's information-security requirements.

Employees are responsible for:

- Protecting passwords and authentication credentials.
- Using approved devices and software.
- Locking their workstation when unattended.
- Following secure remote-access procedures.
- Reporting suspected phishing or security incidents.
- Protecting company devices from unauthorized access.

Passwords must not be shared with other employees or third parties.

8. Conflict of Interest

Employees must avoid situations where personal interests could conflict with their responsibilities to Venus Bank.

Potential conflicts may include:

- Outside employment
- Personal relationships with vendors
- Financial interests in suppliers or competitors
- Accepting inappropriate gifts
- Using company information for personal benefit

Employees must disclose actual or potential conflicts to their manager or HR/Compliance department.

9. Gifts and Entertainment

Employees must not accept gifts, entertainment, discounts, or benefits that could improperly influence business decisions.

Small customary business courtesies may be permitted when consistent with company policy and applicable requirements.

Cash or cash-equivalent gifts from customers, vendors, or business partners are prohibited unless specifically permitted by an approved policy.

10. Fraud and Misconduct

Employees must not participate in, facilitate, conceal, or knowingly ignore fraudulent or dishonest activities.

Examples include:

- Falsifying records
- Misusing customer information
- Manipulating financial information
- Unauthorized transactions
- Misuse of company assets
- Expense fraud
- Deliberate policy violations

Suspected fraud or misconduct should be reported promptly through the approved reporting channel.

11. Use of Company Resources

Company property, systems, applications, devices, data, and other resources must primarily be used for legitimate business purposes.

Employees must protect company assets from theft, misuse, unauthorized access, or damage.

12. Social Media

Employees should exercise appropriate judgment when discussing Venus Bank or work-related matters on social media.

Employees must not disclose confidential information, customer information, internal documents, or non-public business information.

Personal opinions must not be presented as official statements of Venus Bank unless the employee is authorized to do so.

13. Remote Work

Employees working remotely remain subject to the same confidentiality, security, conduct, attendance, and productivity requirements applicable to office-based work.

Employees must ensure that confidential company and customer information cannot be viewed or accessed by unauthorized persons.

14. Compliance with Policies

Employees are expected to understand and comply with applicable Venus Bank policies, procedures, controls, and training requirements.

Failure to comply may result in corrective or disciplinary action.

15. Reporting Concerns

Employees may report concerns through appropriate channels such as:

- Reporting Manager
- Human Resources
- Compliance
- Information Security
- Ethics/Whistleblower Channel

Employees making genuine reports in good faith should not be subjected to retaliation for raising a legitimate concern.

16. Disciplinary Action

Violations of this Code of Conduct may result in corrective or disciplinary action depending on the nature and severity of the violation.

Possible actions may include:

1. Counseling
2. Formal warning

3. Mandatory training
4. Suspension
5. Other disciplinary measures
6. Termination of employment

Serious misconduct may result in immediate escalation in accordance with applicable procedures.

17. Employee Responsibility

Every employee is responsible for understanding and following this Code of Conduct.

Employees should seek clarification from their manager, HR, Compliance, or another appropriate function when they are uncertain about whether an action complies with company policy.

18. Policy Review

Venus Bank may periodically review and update this Code of Conduct to reflect changes in business requirements, organizational practices, applicable regulations, and risk-management standards.

End of Illustrative Code of Conduct